

# D&D 3.5e Magic Rings — Executive Summary & Roadmap

Consolidated from 4 planning documents | Generated 2026-05-24  
Source: DMG 3.5e pp. 229–233 (Core Rules Only)

## At a Glance

| Metric                                                   | Value                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Distinct ring types                                      | 33                                                              |
| Total item variants (counting +1–+5, energy types, etc.) | 47                                                              |
| Implementation tiers                                     | 4                                                               |
| New systems required                                     | 7 (4 major, 3 minor)                                            |
| New files to create                                      | 8                                                               |
| Existing files to modify                                 | 10+                                                             |
| Estimated total effort                                   | 8–10 weeks                                                      |
| Quick wins (Day 1–2)                                     | 5 rings (Protection, Energy Resist, Evasion, FoM, Force Shield) |
| Rings using existing systems only                        | 15 (45%)                                                        |

## Current Codebase Status

### ✓ Already Working

- **Ring equipment slots** — EquipSlot.LeftRing , EquipSlot.RightRing , EquipSlot.EitherRing
- **Inventory slots wired** — Inventory.LeftRingSlot , Inventory.RightRingSlot
- **UI ring slots** — “L RING” / “R RING” displayed in both InventoryUI and PreCombatInventoryUI
- **Spell effect ticking** — GameManager already ticks ring slots for item spell durations
- **Key stats/systems** — DeflectionBonus, DamageResistances, HasEvasion, FoM spell, Invisibility, Blink, Telekinesis, Wish system, Spell Turning, wand charge system, staff charge system, spell slot system

## ✗ Missing

- No ring items registered in ItemDatabase
- No ring stat effects in `RecalculateStats()`
- No ring-specific ItemData fields
- No ring activation system (command word / use-activated)
- No RingFactory (unlike WandFactory/PotionFactory/ScrollFactory)

## Complexity Distribution

|       |                         |                                     |
|-------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| ★     | Simple (12 rings / 36%) | ☐ static flags <b>and</b> bonuses   |
| ★★    | Low ( 9 rings / 27%)    | ☐ simple abilities, existing spells |
| ★★★   | Medium ( 5 rings / 15%) | ☐ daily tracking, spell slot mods   |
| ★★★★  | High ( 4 rings / 12%)   | ☐ new subsystems required           |
| ★★★★★ | V.High ( 3 rings / 9%)  | ☐ multiple new systems + AI         |

## By Activation Type

| Type                | Count | %   |
|---------------------|-------|-----|
| Continuous Passive  | 18    | 55% |
| Command Word Active | 7     | 21% |
| Charged/Expendable  | 3     | 9%  |
| Spell Storage       | 3     | 9%  |
| Multi-Power Complex | 2     | 6%  |

## Priority Quadrant Analysis

### 🟢 Q1: High Impact / Low Complexity — DO FIRST (15 rings, 45%)

Rings of Protection, Resistance, Freedom of Movement, Evasion, Force Shield, Energy Resistance, Wizardry I-IV, Invisibility, Blinking, Counterspells, Sustenance, Climbing, Jumping, Swimming, Mind Shielding.

Est. effort: 1-2 weeks

### 🟡 Q2: High Impact / High Complexity — PLAN CAREFULLY (5 rings, 15%)

Spell Storing (Minor/Standard/Major), Regeneration, Spell Turning.

Est. effort: 2-3 weeks

### ● Q3: Low Impact / Low Complexity — FILL IN GAPS (4 rings, 12%)

Feather Falling, Animal Friendship, Chameleon Power, Water Walking.

Est. effort: 3-5 days

### ● Q4: Low Impact / High Complexity — DEFER (9 rings, 27%)

Ram, Telekinesis, Friend Shield, Shooting Stars, X-Ray Vision, Three Wishes, Elemental Command ×4, Djinni Calling.

Est. effort: 3-4 weeks

## Top 10 Priority Rings (by Impact × Simplicity Score)

| Rank | Ring                             | Score | Why                                               |
|------|----------------------------------|-------|---------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Protection +1-+5                 | 25    | DeflectionBonus field exists; highest-impact ring |
| 2    | Resistance (Minor/Major/Greater) | 25    | Save bonus fields exist                           |
| 3    | Freedom of Movement              | 20    | FoM spell already implemented                     |
| 4    | Evasion                          | 20    | Single flag: HasEvasion = true                    |
| 5    | Force Shield                     | 20    | ShieldBonus field exists                          |
| 6    | Energy Resistance (15 variants)  | 16    | DamageResistances dict exists                     |
| 7    | Wizardry I-IV                    | 16    | High value for spellcasters                       |
| 8    | Invisibility                     | 16    | Existing spell + introduces command word pattern  |
| 9    | Blinking                         | 16    | Existing spell, reuses command word pattern       |
| 10   | Counterspells                    | 16    | Reactive trigger, unique gameplay                 |

## Required New Systems (7 Total)

| # | System                          | Effort   | Unlocks                       | Priority   |
|---|---------------------------------|----------|-------------------------------|------------|
| 1 | <b>Ring Equipment Framework</b> | 2-3 days | ALL 33 rings                  | ● CRITICAL |
| 2 | <b>Command Word Activation</b>  | 2 days   | 9 Tier 2 rings                | ● HIGH     |
| 3 | <b>Ring Charge Tracking</b>     | 1 day    | Ram, Three Wishes             | ● HIGH     |
| 4 | <b>Spell Slot Doubling</b>      | 3 days   | Wizardry I-IV                 | ● HIGH     |
| 5 | <b>Spell Storage</b>            | 4-5 days | Spell Storing, Counterspells  | ● MEDIUM   |
| 6 | <b>Daily Use Tracking</b>       | 2 days   | Shooting Stars, Spell Turning | ● MEDIUM   |
| 7 | <b>Elemental Dominance</b>      | 5-7 days | Elemental Command x4          | ● LOW      |

**Total new system effort: ~19-23 days**

## 4-Sprint Implementation Roadmap

### Sprint 1 — Foundation + Quick Wins (Weeks 1-2)

| Deliverable                  | Details                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ring Framework               | RingFactory.cs , RingDatabase.cs , Ring-Definition.cs , ItemData ring fields                                                     |
| RecalculateStats integration | Ring slots processed for passive bonuses                                                                                         |
| Command Word Activation UI   | Reusable for all active rings                                                                                                    |
| <b>15 rings functional</b>   | Protection, Energy Resistance, Evasion, FoM, Force Shield, Invisibility, Blinking, Wizardry, Counterspells, + 6 flag/skill rings |

## Sprint 2 — Active & Moderate Rings (Weeks 3-4)

| Deliverable                    | Details                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spell Storage subsystem        | Reusable for other item types                                                                                |
| Charge depletion system        | Extends wand pattern                                                                                         |
| <b>8 more rings (23 total)</b> | Spell Storing Minor/Std, Regeneration, Feather Falling, Animal Friendship, Chameleon Power, Ram, Telekinesis |

## Sprint 3 — Complex Rings (Weeks 5-7)

| Deliverable                    | Details                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spell reflection system        | For Spell Turning                                                                              |
| Multi-ability ring framework   | For Shooting Stars                                                                             |
| Paired item prototype          | For Friend Shield                                                                              |
| <b>6 more rings (29 total)</b> | Spell Storing Major, Spell Turning, Water Walking, Three Wishes, Shooting Stars, Friend Shield |

## Sprint 4 — Legendary Rings (Weeks 8-10)

| Deliverable                    | Details                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Elemental Command framework    | 4 variants sharing one system                      |
| Summoning/Calling subsystem    | For Djinni Calling                                 |
| <b>4 more rings (33 total)</b> | X-Ray Vision, Elemental Command ×4, Djinni Calling |

## Quick Wins (Implement in First 2 Days)

These 5 rings can be implemented almost immediately once the Ring Framework exists, because every stat field they need is already in the codebase:

1. **Ring of Protection +1-+5** → set `DeflectionBonus` (already used by Shield of Faith)
2. **Ring of Evasion** → set `HasEvasion = true` (already used by Rogue/Monk)
3. **Ring of Energy Resistance** (15 variants) → add to `DamageResistances` dict
4. **Ring of Freedom of Movement** → apply existing FoM continuous buff
5. **Ring of Force Shield** → set `ShieldBonus = 2` when toggled active

## Dependency Tree (Simplified)

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Ring Equipment Framework ← MUST BUILD FIRST
├── Passive Rings (Tier 1) ← existing stat systems
├── Command Word Activation System
│   ├── Spell-Like Rings (Invisibility, Blink, Telekinesis, etc.)
│   └── Charged Rings (Ram, Three Wishes)
├── Spell Slot Doubling → Wizardry I–IV
├── Spell Storage System → Spell Storing, Counterspells
├── Daily Use Tracking → Shooting Stars, Spell Turning
└── Summoning + Elemental Dominance → Djinni Calling, Elemental Command ×4
  
```

## Risk Register

| Risk                                                           | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RecalculateStats()<br>ring integration<br>breaks existing gear | Medium     | High   | Unit test all equipment before/after                              |
| Command activation<br>UI delays                                | Medium     | Medium | Stub with auto-activate; add UI later                             |
| Spell storage system<br>scope creep                            | High       | Medium | Implement Minor first, gate Major behind it                       |
| Elemental Command<br>scope explosion                           | High       | High   | Implement as simplified stat rings first; add modes incrementally |
| Ring of Three Wishes<br>balance issues                         | Low        | High   | Gate behind DM confirmation dialog                                |

## File Impact Summary

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### 8 New Files

|                             |                                                                     |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RingDefinition.cs           | <input type="checkbox"/> Data structure <b>for</b> ring definitions |
| RingDatabase.cs             | <input type="checkbox"/> Registry of all 33 ring types              |
| RingFactory.cs              | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring item generation                       |
| RingEffectType.cs           | <input type="checkbox"/> Enum <b>for</b> ring effect types          |
| SpellStorageData.cs         | <input type="checkbox"/> Spell storage <b>for</b> rings             |
| RingActivationPanel.cs      | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring activation UI                         |
| SpellStorageUI.cs           | <input type="checkbox"/> Spell store/retrieve UI                    |
| ElementalDominanceSystem.cs | <input type="checkbox"/> Elemental command framework                |

### 10+ Modified Files

|                         |                                                             |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| ItemData.cs             | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring-specific fields               |
| Inventory.cs            | <input type="checkbox"/> RecalculateStats() ring processing |
| ItemDatabase.cs         | <input type="checkbox"/> CloneItem() ring field copying     |
| GameManager.cs          | <input type="checkbox"/> TryUseItem() ring branch           |
| SceneBootstrap.cs       | <input type="checkbox"/> RingDatabase initialization        |
| CharacterStats.cs       | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring-derived stats                 |
| ItemIDs.cs              | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring item ID constants             |
| PreCombatInventoryUI.cs | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring tooltip updates               |
| InventoryUI.cs          | <input type="checkbox"/> Ring display                       |
| SpellSlotCalculator.cs  | <input type="checkbox"/> Wizardry doubling logic            |

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Executive summary consolidating: rings\_implementation\_plan.md, rings\_by\_complexity.md, ring\_systems\_required.md, rings\_priority\_matrix.md